



Civic Meeting Report

Muncie Sanitary District Meeting November 27th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5PCRrq-8EJY
Publication Date	2024-11-27T16:57:48Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Muncie Sanitary District: Board of Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: November 27, 2024

Report Publication: Comprehensive Municipal Meeting Report

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Muncie Sanitary District Board of Commissioners was called to order at **00:00:21** on November 27, 2024, by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present in Person:** Four board members.
 - **Present Online:** Tim Overton.
 - **Quorum:** Established.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding officer **00:00:28**.

- **Approval of Minutes:** 00:01:15 The board considered the previous meeting's minutes from November 13th.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

Register of Claims

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:01:48 Consideration of the Register of Claims totaling \$1,887,232.22.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board members and staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Board members highlighted several major claims for public transparency:
 - \$247,800.00 (Page 11) and \$247,800.00 (Page 14) for partial payments on new trash trucks for sanitation.
 - \$29,035.00 (Page 12) to Baker Tilly Municipal Advisors for finishing the cost-of-service study.
 - \$5,950.00 (Page 13) for storm water work at the McCullough Park lift station (part of the combined system).
 - Approximately \$81,000 total across multiple entries for E. Central Recycling (ECR) regarding parks and household waste/disposal.
 - \$6,000.00 (Page 6) for fall cleanup on the levy.
 - Approximately \$8,100.00 for sweeper dumpings through November.
 - \$42,988.84 (Page 9) to Special Earth Sciences for waste pollution control facility remediation, plot testing, and underground test work.
 - \$3,919.56 (Page 9) for sludge tipping fees at Randolph Farms.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:04:54.

Release of Retainage: Bone Engineering

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:07:36 Release of Retainage to Bone Engineering.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad (District Administrator).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Rick Conrad presented the request for the release of final retainage for Bone's on-call storm water work, primarily concerning construction that took place on Hoy Street. The project is complete.
- **Financial Amount:** \$325,900.00.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:08:42.

Resolution 2024-8: Transfer of Funds

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:08:51](#) Resolution 2024-8: Transfer of Funds within the Muncie Sanitary District.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad (District Administrator).
- **Deliberation Summary:** A request to move \$80,000 from the sanitation disposal services account to the salary and wages account. The salary budget was tight due to the addition of code enforcement officers and a gap between the budgeted 3% salary increase forecast and the board-approved 5% salary increase.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:10:33](#).

Resolution 2024-9: Septic Vendor and Hauling Rate Increase

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:10:48](#) Resolution 2024-9: Rate Increase for Septic Vendors and Hauling.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad (District Administrator).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Staff proposed increasing dumping fees for septic waste at the treatment facility to offset rising costs for solids removal, landfill hauling, and Bureau of Water Quality monitoring/lab testing.
 - Fees for 0 to 2,000 gallons increase from \$90.00 to \$200.00.
 - Fees for greater than 2,000 gallons increase from \$135.00 to \$300.00.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Board members noted this aligns rates with surrounding regions and supports process improvement goals to reduce the financial burden on local ratepayers.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:12:54](#).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:01:01](#) The presiding officer opened the floor for public comment near the beginning of the meeting. No members of the public approached the podium to speak.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

Staff & Board Reports

- **District Administrator Update ([00:05:13](#)):** Rick Conrad reported on Leaf Season, noting final pickups were scheduled for that day and Saturday. Residents can still take leaves to ECR (unbagged), as landfill dumping is discouraged. Conrad thanked residents using paper bags or mulching leaves.
- **Long-Term Control Plan RFQ Update ([00:13:13](#)):** Board member Adam announced that following the publication of a Request for Qualifications (RFQ) for engineering consultants

for the long-term control plan, six responses were received. The top three selected consultants are:

1. Lochmueller Group
2. Thailand (sp.)
3. American Structurepoint

Scopes of work will be prepared with these three firms.

- **Tax Draw & Leaf Bag PSA (00:15:10):** The presiding officer announced receipt of the fall tax draw distribution. A Public Service Announcement (PSA) was issued warning residents that paper bags will likely be mandated for leaf collection next year due to safety hazards, contamination, and handling issues associated with plastic bags.
- **Disaster Reimbursement (00:16:14):** The district received an \$88,000 reimbursement from the state for sanitation district response costs related to the April tornado that impacted Delaware County, Selma, and Winchester.
- **Billing Audits (00:16:47):** Tom and his team are auditing addresses connected to infrastructure but missing from the billing system (e.g., discovering 5 connected/discharging addresses out of roughly 130 inspected, out of 5,000 total to review). Verified connections are added via rigorous verification processes including dye tests.

Adjournment

- **Schedule Note:** The next regular board meeting is scheduled for December 11, 2024, at 11:30 AM in the City Hall Auditorium (the December 25th Christmas meeting is cancelled).
- **Adjournment Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:18:34.